



Position Specification

Confidential
General Manager – IT

February, 2015

Company	Confidential
Position	General Manager – IT
Location	Dubai, UAE
Reporting to	Group Finance Director (CFO)
Website	Confidential

Company Background

The company was founded over 50 years ago by a notable and prestigious UAE family group whose vision and entrepreneurship has resulted in the formation of a widely diversified group. Today, under the leadership of its Chairman, the group comprises of 25+ autonomous companies - specializing in sectors as diverse as automotive, healthcare, manufacturing, engineering, electronics, FMCG, food, real estate and education.

The company is proud to be one of the oldest and larger private business holdings in the UAE, with continued commitment to extend its reach further into the region. Its momentum comes from a founding ambition to improve the quality of life of its people, customers and society. Across the group the company challenges itself to create new opportunities, look beyond conventional boundaries and to embrace progress through innovation.

These principles are reflected in partnerships and knowledge sharing with global leaders in multiple market segments. For over 50 years the company has championed good business practices and is trusted to represent the world's top brands.

Today, overall group turnover is approximately USD\$2 billion with over 5,000 staff spread across the GCC and internationally.

The company invested heavily in its IT and technology platform. In 1999 it adopted SAP to facilitate and enable the continued growth of the operating groups and its portfolio companies. Today it operates SAP across all these businesses. The IT function is split into two separate functions; an Information Technology and Data Processing department (ITDP), and an Information System and Support department (ISS). ITDP ensures efficient and smooth running of the facility, where ISS ensures effective usage of the system by the businesses. ISS includes business consultants – expert in their own modules – who support businesses to ensure effective usage of each of the modules.

Whilst notable investment in IT has been made, significant effort is required to realise the full potential and effectiveness of a world-class IT function. In particular, to use SAP as a true ERP system, supporting all areas of business, rather than restricted to churning out financial numbers and storage of data. Hence the group see prudent to hire an outstanding executive to lead, manage and drive the IT organisation for the future. The General Manager – IT will set overall technology direction and drive projects to leverage and optimize the plentiful opportunities of increasing the full and effective usage of IT capability within the operating groups and portfolio companies, thereby achieving group-wide objectives and a high return on investment.

Role/Responsibility

Reporting to the Group Finance Director (CFO), the role of the General Manager – IT is to lead and develop a collaborative solutions-oriented IT capability that delivers group-wide solutions across all functions, thereby having a material impact to the bottom line profitability to all its businesses.

Specifically, responsibilities include the following:

- Develop, coordinate, guide and maintain the IT departments' strategic and operational plans in support of the holding's strategic plan
- Propose, track, and control the department's IT annual budget to meet objectives of the business in the most cost effective fashion possible
- Partner with senior leadership and proactively identify opportunities to align technology initiatives with the operating groups and their portfolio companies; institutionalize a business support function
- Prepare business case and present process enhancement recommendations based on prudent analysis and cost effectiveness
- Leverage IT assets to enhance profit through effective usage of technology including the SAP ERP; tailor IT and SAP to meet client needs, improving, optimizing and strengthening the business processes in the back office and throughout the business operations
- Ensure all users and management are using and optimizing SAP fully in all aspects of their day-to-day work
- Maintain effective working relationships and interaction with users to ensure alignment of SAP ERP and business objectives
- Ensure continuous and satisfactory delivery of IT services through the definition and oversight of service level agreements, where defined with internal clients
- Translate and clarify the business vision and the scope of the work to the PMO and technical teams

- Supervise recruitment, development, retention, and organization of all managed staff in accordance with corporate budgetary and policy requirements; establish KPI's and benchmarks for self, team and department
- Effectively manage outside vendor resources; negotiate best terms and support
- Ensure all IT activity is consistent with governance and control requirements as defined by the executive leadership
- Be part of the management team to help and support businesses to achieve their growth and performance

Ideal Candidate

- At least 5+ years of experience in managing teams and leading the IT function in a commercial business environment with several companies in different industries (not in a consultancy)
- Strong ERP full cycle exposure with a preference in SAP; running and supervising SAP in a commercial environment (not only implementing SAP modules)
- Information Technology/Computer Science Degree
- Strong communicator and interpersonal skills to relate to the users at all levels and supporting them in all business areas; strong stakeholder management skills at all levels
- Commercially savvy; ability to align technology initiatives with business initiatives to provide ROI
- Pragmatic and pro-active with a 24x7 attitude to satisfy the needs of all users of the system across businesses and functions
- Able to identify cost effective solutions to enable business and users to perform better
- Ability to think out of the box and propose solution which are not restricted by IT needs
- Able to motivate users to utilise the resources available to the optimum
- Able to lead and motivate team, indoctrinate a sense of service provider
- Commercial minded in terms of running the IT department budget and also running the department on the basis of contribution to the results of the business
- Constantly on the lookout for the solutions which helps to bring cost ratios down, measure and demonstrate the progress
- Ability to maintain cordial and business relationship with all vendors

- Keeping self and team constantly up-to-date with latest trend in IT and related field, identify opportunities, which will help to keep the organisation at the cutting edge
- Willing to spend time in the businesses, identify opportunities, develop a roadmap, and obtain buy-in of the businesses and users across companies and functions
- One of the major KPIs and success criteria to be to achieve is the full and effective usage of the system and make ERP a backbone of business results and success

Contact

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